Ideation Phase

Brainstorm & Idea Prioritization Template

Date	24 October 2026
Team ID	
Project Name	Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow
Maximum Marks	4 Marks

Step 1: Select the Problem Statement

Problem Statement

IT incidents are often reported by email, phone or informal channels. They are then poorly tracked, inconsistently classified, escalated late and hard to follow to resolution. Without a structured incident process, issues stay unresolved, SLAs can be breached and root causes are difficult to trace.

Project Idea

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow standardises the whole incident lifecycle in the Incident module. A Service Desk agent creates and classifies the incident, uses Agent Assist knowledge, and reassigns it to a Level 2 team. The Level 2 technician investigates, raises an emergency change request, creates a child incident for recurring issues, documents the cause and resolution, and creates a knowledge article. SLAs and related records stay visible throughout.

Objective

To let Service Desk agents create and classify incidents, use knowledge for faster resolution, reassign to the right support group, let Level 2 technicians investigate and resolve, create emergency changes and child incidents from the incident, generate knowledge articles from resolved incidents, and improve SLA compliance and service visibility.

Step 2: Brainstorm, List and Group Ideas

The ideas below were listed from the project goals and then grouped by the stage of the lifecycle they support.

No.	Idea	Description	Group
1	Incident record creation	Create the incident in Service Operations Workspace with a clear short description and caller.	Capture and classify
2	Incident classification	Set category, subcategory, urgency, service, service offering and configuration item, and record the channel.	Capture and classify
3	Knowledge integration	Use Agent Assist to find articles from the short description, mark one helpful and attach it.	Assist and route
4	Reassignment and escalation	Move the incident to the Network group, clear Assigned to, and add the watch list and work notes list.	Assist and route

No.	Idea	Description	Group
5	Emergency change request	Create an emergency change request from the incident and keep it linked.	Coordinate related work
6	Child incident creation	Create a child incident for repeat reports of the same issue and track it from the parent.	Coordinate related work
7	Cause and resolution documentation	Record the probable cause, resolution code and resolution notes before resolving.	Resolve and learn
8	Knowledge article creation	Create a knowledge article from the resolved incident in the IT knowledge base.	Resolve and learn
9	SLA and related record tracking	Show Task SLAs, child incidents, change requests and knowledge in Related Records.	Monitor

Step 3: Idea Prioritization

Each idea was rated for impact on the problem and for ease of implementation in ServiceNow. Ideas with high impact that other steps depend on are done first.

No.	Idea	Impact	Ease	Priority	Order of work
1	Incident record creation	High	High	High	First
2	Incident classification	High	High	High	Second
3	Knowledge integration	High	Medium	High	Third
4	Reassignment and escalation	High	High	High	Fourth
5	Emergency change request	Medium	Medium	Medium	Fifth
6	Child incident creation	Medium	High	Medium	Sixth
7	Cause and resolution documentation	High	High	High	Seventh
8	Knowledge article creation	Medium	Medium	Medium	Eighth
9	SLA and related record tracking	High	Medium	High	Ninth, as final validation

Ratings: High, Medium. Priority is the combination of impact and ease.

Priority Summary

Priority	Ideas	Reason
High	Record creation, classification, knowledge integration, reassignment, cause and resolution documentation, SLA and related record tracking.	These are the core steps every incident goes through and they decide whether SLAs are met.
Medium	Emergency change request, child incident creation, knowledge article creation.	These add coordination, traceability and reuse once the core steps work.

Selected Idea

A ServiceNow incident process that runs from creation and classification, through knowledge-assisted investigation and reassignment, to emergency change, child incidents, documented resolution, a new knowledge article and visible SLAs. The VPN incident reported by Michael Hoefer is used to demonstrate it from start to finish.